SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #9 · WEALTH AND PRIVILEGE

"I must never let anyone see me struggle."

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Where it often comes from

In families, workplaces, and communities where success is a sign of status, struggle can feel like exposure. A parent who always looked fine, a culture of "keeping up appearances," or a past experience when vulnerability was used against us can teach us to hide. The cost is quiet: stress, secrecy, and loneliness among people who think everything is fine.

What Scripture teaches

Paul wrote that Christ told him, "My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness." We are told to bear one another's burdens, to confess to one another and pray for one another, and to approach the throne of grace with confidence to find help in time of need. God never asked us to look strong. He invites us to bring our weakness to Him and to safe people, because help flows toward honesty.

> *"But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me"* (2 Corinthians 12:9).

Also see

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail" (James 5:16).

> "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken" (Psalm 55:22).

> "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16).

Common self-statements

- If they knew I was struggling, they would lose respect for me.
- I have to look like I have it all together.
- Needing help means I have failed.
- Struggle is for other people.
- I cannot afford to be seen as weak.
- I will handle it alone.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that others will judge me if they see my struggle.
- Should statements: Insisting that I must always appear strong.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either fine or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know what others would think of my struggle.

Challenging questions

- What have I been hiding, and what has hiding cost me?
- Who has been honest with me about their struggles, and what did I think of them?
- What do I believe would happen if one safe person knew?
- What does God say about weakness?
- Where did I learn that struggle must be hidden?
- Who is one safe person I could tell?

Truth summary

> Everyone struggles, and hiding it does not make me stronger. God's grace meets me in my weakness, and He gives me people to help carry what I cannot carry alone. I can choose a safe person and let myself be known.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Help
- Hardship
- Troubles
- Confession

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Trouble/Hardship

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must never let anyone see me struggle"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must never let anyone see me struggle." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I been hiding?
- ☐ What has hiding cost me?
- ☐ Who is a safe person I could tell?
- ☐ What does God say about weakness?
- ☐ What is one honest step I can take?
- ☐ Where did I learn to hide struggle?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I do not have to look strong to be loved.
- ☐ God's power shows up in my weakness.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise, not weak.
- ☐ Everyone struggles in some way.
- ☐ Safe people can carry part of my load.
- ☐ I can let myself be known.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 12:9**
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ **Galatians 6:2**
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ **Hebrews 4:16**
  "Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I let someone see: Each week, note one honest thing you shared with a safe person, and what happened afterward.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 12:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God's grace is enough for me, even when I am weak, so I can let a safe person help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Name one safe person. Choose someone who is trustworthy, discreet, and kind.
- [ ] Share one real struggle. Tell that person one honest thing and notice how they respond.
- [ ] Pray with honesty. Tell God exactly where you are struggling, without polish.
- [ ] Reach out for practical help. If the struggle involves money, health, or family, contact a counselor, advisor, or pastor this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must never let anyone see me struggle": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	An honest moment
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must never let anyone see me struggle.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You see my struggle and You are not ashamed of me. Give me courage to be honest with You and with safe people. Let Your power be made perfect in my weakness. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.